

STUDY NOTES · UPSSSC PET 2026

General English — Basic Grammar

UPSSSC PET 2026 Detailed Notes

31 August 2026

General English

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General English — Basic Grammar

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Learning sequence: Concept → Rule → Examples → Common Errors → Exam Tip → Practice

Hindi Help: कठिन या confusing points पर ही short Hindi support दिया जाएगा। बाकी explanation English में रहेगा।



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Part A — Parts of Speech

Parts of speech classify words according to their grammatical function in a sentence. A word must be identified from its **context and function**.

Part	Function	Examples
Noun	names a person, place, thing, animal, quality, or idea	teacher, Delhi, honesty
Pronoun	stands for/refers to a noun or noun phrase	he, she, they
Adjective	modifies/describes a noun or pronoun	honest, tall, three
Verb	expresses action, occurrence, or state	run, write, seem
Adverb	modifies a verb, adjective, adverb, or clause	quickly, very, often
Preposition	expresses a relationship	in, on, between
Conjunction	connects words, phrases, or clauses	and, but, because
Interjection	expresses sudden feeling	Oh!, Alas!
Article	marks a noun as general/specific	a, an, the

Core Concept

****Context matters:**** - ****Fast**** is an adjective in “a fast car”. - ****Fast**** is an adverb in “He runs fast”.

Exam Tip

****Hindi Help:**** Part of Speech = sentence में word का grammatical function.

Part B — Nouns

A **noun** names a person, place, thing, animal, substance, quality, state, or idea.

Types of Nouns

- **Proper:** Rahul, India, Monday
- **Common:** boy, country, city
- **Collective:** team, committee, crowd
- **Abstract:** honesty, beauty, courage
- **Material:** gold, water, milk
- **Countable:** book, apple, student
- **Uncountable:** advice, information, furniture, luggage

⚠ Warning

Do not normally write ****advices, informations, furnitures, luggages**** in standard English. Use: ****a piece of advice, some information, a piece of furniture****.

Number

- Singular: book, child, woman
- Plural: books, children, women

Important Irregular Plurals

Singular	Plural
man	men
woman	women
child	children
foot	feet
tooth	teeth
mouse	mice
person	people

Possessive Nouns

- Rahul's book
- the boys' bags
- the children's toys

∴ trap Some words ending in **-s** can be singular in meaning: **news, mathematics**. Always judge from the sentence. ∴

Part C — Pronouns

A **pronoun** is used in place of, or to refer to, a noun/noun phrase.

Types

Type	Examples
Personal	I, we, you, he, she, it, they
Possessive	mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs
Reflexive	myself, yourself, himself, herself, themselves
Demonstrative	this, that, these, those
Relative	who, whom, whose, which, that
Interrogative	who, whom, whose, which, what
Indefinite	someone, anyone, nobody, each, several
Reciprocal	each other, one another

Antecedent Agreement

A pronoun should normally agree appropriately with its antecedent in **number and person**.

- Riya finished **her** work.
- The students finished **their** work.

Who, Whom, Whose

- **Who** → subject/person performing an action.
- **Whom** → object in formal usage.
- **Whose** → possession.

Who called you?
Whom did you meet?
Whose book is this?

 Exam Tip

Formal test: if the answer would be **he/she**, use **who**; if **him/her**, **whom** may be appropriate.



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Part D — Adjectives

An **adjective** describes, identifies, or gives information about a noun/pronoun.

Degrees of Comparison

Degree	Example
Positive	tall
Comparative	taller
Superlative	tallest

Irregular forms:

- good → better → best
- bad → worse → worst
- little → less → least
- many/much → more → most

Warning

Avoid double comparison: ⊗ more better ⊗ most tallest ✓ better ✓ tallest

Order of Adjectives — Basic Rule

When several adjectives occur before a noun, a common order is:

Opinion → Size → Age → Shape → Colour → Origin → Material → Purpose + Noun

a beautiful small old round red Italian wooden table

This order is a guideline; natural English does not always require every category.

Part E — Verbs

A **verb** expresses an action, occurrence, or state.

Main Verb

She **writes** every day.

Auxiliary Verbs

- **be:** am, is, are, was, were, been, being
- **have:** have, has, had
- **do:** do, does, did

Modal Auxiliaries

Modal	Common meaning/use	Example
can	ability/possibility	She can swim.
could	past ability/polite possibility/request	Could you help me?
may	permission/possibility	May I come in?
might	weaker possibility	It might rain.
must	strong obligation/deduction	You must obey the rule.
should	advice/expectation	You should study.
will	future/willingness	I will help you.
would	polite request/hypothetical use	Would you help me?

🔑 Remember

After a modal, use the **base form (V1)**: - can **swim** - should **study** - must **leave** Not:
⊗ can swims / ⊗ should studied

Transitive and Intransitive Verbs

Transitive: takes a direct object in the construction.

She **opened the door**.

Intransitive: does not take a direct object in the construction.

The baby **slept**.

Verb Forms

Form	Example
V1	go
V2	went
V3	gone
V-ing	going
V1+s/es	goes

::: trap After **did**, use V1: **Did he go?** not **Did he went?** :::

Part F — Non-Finite Verbs

Non-finite verb forms do not show tense/person agreement in the same way as finite verbs.

Infinitive

Usually **to + V1**:

I want **to learn**.

A bare infinitive is used after many modals:

You must **go**.

Gerund

The **V-ing** form functioning as a noun:

Reading is useful.

Participle

Participles can function in verb phrases or as modifiers.

- Present participle: **running** water
- Past participle: **broken** glass

∴ trap Do not treat every **-ing** word as a gerund. Its function in the sentence matters. ∴

Part G — Adverbs

An adverb can modify a verb, adjective, another adverb, or an entire clause.

Common Types

- Manner: slowly, carefully
- Time: now, yesterday, soon
- Place: here, there
- Frequency: always, often, never
- Degree: very, quite, too, almost

Examples:

- He runs **quickly**.
- She is **very** intelligent.
- He runs **quite** quickly.
- **Fortunately**, nobody was hurt.

Warning

Not every **-ly** word is an adverb. **Friendly** is commonly an adjective; **fast** can function as an adverb.

Part H — Prepositions

A preposition expresses a relationship of time, place, direction, cause, manner, or another kind.

Time

Preposition	Common use	Example
at	exact time	at 5 p.m.
on	day/date	on Monday
in	month/year/period	in July; in 2026
since	starting point	since Monday
for	duration	for two hours
by	deadline	by 6 p.m.
during	within a period/event	during the meeting

Place and Direction

- **in** → inside
- **on** → surface
- **at** → point/location
- **into** → movement to the inside
- **under** → lower than
- **above** → higher than
- **between** → relation between separately identified entities
- **among** → within a group

Commonly Confused Pairs

In / Into

The child is **in** the room.

The child went **into** the room.

By / With

The poem was written **by** Tagore.

He cut it **with** a knife.

Beside / Besides

- beside = next to
- besides = in addition to

⚡ Trick

****Besides = in addition.**** ****Beside = next to.****

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Part I — Conjunctions

A conjunction connects words, phrases, or clauses.

Coordinating Conjunctions

FANBOYS: For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So.

Subordinating Conjunctions

because, although, if, when, unless, while, before, after, since, etc.

Correlative Conjunctions

- either...or
- neither...nor
- both...and
- not only...but also
- whether...or

💡 Exam Tip

Correlative conjunctions should normally connect grammatically parallel elements. > She likes
both singing and dancing.

Part J — Articles and Determiners

Articles

A

Use **a** before a singular countable noun when the following sound is a consonant sound.

a book, a university, a European country

An

Use **an** before a singular countable noun when the following sound is a vowel sound.

an apple, an hour, an honest man, an MBA

⚡ Trick

****A/An depends on sound, not spelling.****

The

Use **the** when the noun is specific/identified and in several established expressions.

I saw a dog. **The dog** was barking.

The sun rises in the east.

Zero Article

No article is often used with plural or uncountable nouns when speaking generally:

Books are useful.

Water is essential for life.

Determiners

Determiners help identify or quantify nouns.

Common groups:

- Demonstratives: this, that, these, those
- Possessives: my, your, his, her, our, their
- Quantifiers: some, any, much, many, few, little, several, enough
- Distributives: each, every, either, neither
- Numbers: one, two, first, second

Few / A Few / Little / A Little

- **few** → almost none; countable plural
- **a few** → some; countable plural
- **little** → almost none; uncountable
- **a little** → some; uncountable

Few students attended.

A few students attended.

There is little water left.

There is a little water left.

⚠ Warning

****Much/many:**** much → uncountable; many → countable plural.

Part K — Tenses

Tense/aspect expresses time and the way an event is viewed.

12-Tense Framework

Time	Simple	Continuous	Perfect	Perfect Continuous
Present	V1 / V1+s/es	am/is/are + V-ing	has/have + V3	has/have been + V-ing
Past	V2	was/were + V-ing	had + V3	had been + V-ing
Future	will + V1	will be + V-ing	will have + V3	will have been + V-ing

Present Simple

Structure: Subject + V1/V1+s-es

Uses: habits, routines, facts, general truths, suitable schedules.

He **goes** to school every day.

The sun **rises** in the east.

Present Continuous

Structure: am/is/are + V-ing

She **is studying** now.

Used for actions happening around now, temporary situations, and suitable arrangements.

Present Perfect

Structure: has/have + V3

I **have finished** my work.

Used for past events with present relevance, experiences, and certain situations continuing to the present.

::: trap A finished past-time marker such as **yesterday** normally takes the past simple rather than present perfect.

⊗ I have seen him yesterday.

⊙ I saw him yesterday. :::

Present Perfect Continuous

Structure: has/have been + V-ing

She **has been studying** for two hours.

Past Simple

Structure: V2

They **visited** Agra last year.

Past Continuous

Structure: was/were + V-ing

I **was reading** when he called.

Past Perfect

Structure: had + V3

The train **had left** before we reached the station.

Past Perfect Continuous

Structure: had been + V-ing

He **had been working** for three hours before the break.

Future Simple

Structure: will + V1

I **will call** you tomorrow.

Future Continuous

Structure: will be + V-ing

This time tomorrow, I **will be travelling**.

Future Perfect

Structure: will have + V3

By Friday, she **will have completed** the work.

Future Perfect Continuous

Structure: will have been + V-ing

By June, he **will have been teaching** for ten years.

Formula

Pattern memory: - Continuous → **BE + V-ing** - Perfect → **HAVE + V3** - Perfect Continuous → **HAVE + BEEN + V-ing** - After **will** → **V1** - After **did** → **V1**

Part L — Subject-Verb Agreement

The verb agrees with the grammatical subject in person and number.

Core Rules

1. He **works** hard. / They **work** hard.
2. Intervening phrases do not normally change agreement: **The quality of these products is good.**
3. Each/every/everyone/everybody/someone/nobody normally take singular verbs.
4. With either...or / neither...nor, the verb commonly agrees with the nearer subject in standard exam constructions.
5. **along with, as well as, together with** do not normally make the main subject plural.
6. There **is** a book. / There **are** two books.
7. A collective noun can take singular or plural agreement depending on meaning and variety of English; follow the context and exam convention.

∴ trap **Nearest noun ≠ automatically the subject.** Find the grammatical subject first. ∴

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Part M — Sentence Structure

Understanding sentence structure helps with error detection, transformation, and comprehension.

Phrase

A group of words functioning as a unit but normally without a finite verb.

in the morning

Clause

A group of words containing a subject-verb relationship.

when he arrived

Main Types of Sentences by Structure

Simple

One independent clause.

She works hard.

Compound

Two or more independent clauses joined appropriately.

She works hard, **and** she studies regularly.

Complex

One main clause + one or more subordinate clauses.

She works hard **because she wants to succeed**.

 Exam Tip

****Independent clause**** can stand as a sentence. A ****dependent/subordinate clause**** cannot normally stand alone in the same way.



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Part N — Active and Passive Voice

Active Voice

The subject performs the action.

The teacher **checked the answer**.

Passive Voice

The grammatical subject receives the action.

The answer **was checked by the teacher**.

Conversion Steps

1. Identify the active object.
2. Move it to passive subject position.
3. Choose the correct form of **be**.
4. Use V3.
5. Add the agent with **by** when useful.
6. Preserve tense and meaning.

Formula

****Active:**** Subject + Verb + Object ****Passive:**** Object + appropriate BE + V3 + (by + Subject)

Common Patterns

Active	Passive
writes	is/am/are written
wrote	was/were written
is writing	is/am/are being written
has written	has/have been written
had written	had been written
will write	will be written
can write	can be written

Imperative and Modal Examples

Open the door. → **Let the door be opened.**

You must obey the rule. → **The rule must be obeyed.**

⚠ Warning

A normal passive transformation requires a suitable transitive construction. Do not force a passive form for every intransitive verb.

Part O — Direct and Indirect Speech

Direct Speech

The speaker's exact words are quoted.

He said, "I am tired."

Indirect Speech

The meaning is reported without quoting the exact words.

He said that he was tired.

Conversion Checklist

1. Reporting verb
2. Pronouns
3. Tense/backshift where required
4. Time/place expressions
5. Sentence type
6. Connector

Common Time/Place Changes

Direct	Common indirect equivalent
now	then
today	that day
tomorrow	the next day
yesterday	the previous day
here	there
this	that
these	those

Statements

He said, "I am busy." → He said that he was busy.

Questions

He said, "Are you ready?" → He asked whether I was ready.

∴ trap Indirect questions use **statement word order**:

⊗ He asked where was I going.

✓ He asked where I was going. ∴

Commands / Requests / Advice

The teacher said to me, "Open the book."

The teacher told me to open the book.

The reporting verb should reflect the meaning: **told, ordered, requested, advised, warned**, etc.

Exclamatory Sentences

The reporting verb may change according to the emotion expressed, such as **exclaimed with joy/sorrow/surprise**.



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Part P — Common Error Detection

Incorrect	Correct	Rule
He do his work.	He does his work.	3rd-person singular
Did he went?	Did he go?	did + V1
She is more better.	She is better.	no double comparison
He is an university student.	He is a university student.	sound-based article
I have seen him yesterday.	I saw him yesterday.	finished past time
Everyone are ready.	Everyone is ready.	singular indefinite pronoun
She is good in English.	She is good at English.	standard collocation
He discussed about the issue.	He discussed the issue.	discuss + object

💡 Exam Tip

For error detection, check: ****Subject-Verb → Tense → Article/Determiner → Preposition → Pronoun → Modifier → Word usage****

Part Q — Confusing Word Pairs

These are common exam-error areas.

Word	Meaning/Use	Example
advice	noun	He gave me advice.
advise	verb	I advise you to study.
affect	usually verb	Noise can affect health.
effect	usually noun	The effect was clear.
accept	receive/agree	He accepted the offer.
except	excluding	Everyone came except Ravi.
principal	head/main	school principal
principle	rule/belief	moral principle
stationery	writing materials	buy stationery
stationary	not moving	The car remained stationary.

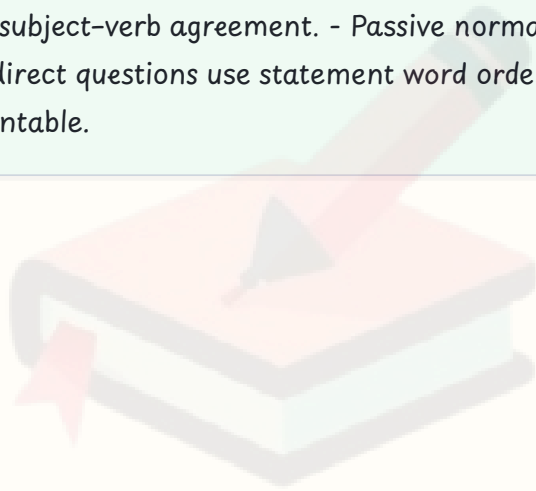
Part R — Hindi Help: Quick Grammar Map

English	Short Hindi Help
Noun	नाम बताने वाला word
Pronoun	Noun के स्थान/संदर्भ में आने वाला word
Adjective	Noun/Pronoun की विशेषता बताता है
Verb	Action/State बताता है
Adverb	Verb/Adjective/Adverb को modify करता है
Preposition	संबंध/स्थान/समय आदि बताता है
Conjunction	words/clauses को जोड़ता है
Article	noun के reference को mark करता है
Determiner	noun को identify/quantify करता है
Tense	time/aspect की grammatical expression
Voice	subject/object की grammatical role बताता है
Narration	कही गई बात को report करने का तरीका

Part S — Master Revision Sheet

Remember

- Part of Speech → identify by **function and context**. - Countable and uncountable nouns behave differently. - Pronouns need a clear, appropriate antecedent. - Comparative/superlative forms should not be doubled. - Modal → **V1**. - did → **V1**. - Continuous → **BE + V-ing**. - Perfect → **HAVE + V3**. - A/An → **sound**, not spelling. - Since → starting point; for → duration. - Subject controls subject-verb agreement. - Passive normally requires a suitable transitive construction. - Indirect questions use statement word order. - Few/a few → countable plural; little/a little → uncountable.



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Part T — Practice Set

Practice

Section A — Grammar MCQs **1.** Which word is an abstract noun? A. table B. honesty C. teacher D. Delhi **2.** He is ___ honest man. A. a B. an C. the D. no article **3.** She did not ___ to school. A. went B. goes C. go D. going **4.** Everyone ___ ready. A. are B. were C. is D. have **5.** She has lived here ___ 2020. A. for B. since C. during D. by **6.** Which is correct? A. He can swims. B. He can swim. C. He can swimming. D. He can swam. **7.** Identify the adverb: The child answered quickly. A. child B. answered C. quickly D. the **8.** Which is correct? A. Did she went there? B. Did she goes there? C. Did she go there? D. Did she going there? **9.** The quality of these products ___ good. A. are B. were C. is D. have **10.** He studies at ___ university. A. an B. a C. the D. no article **11.** By Friday, she ___ the work. A. completes B. completed C. will have completed D. has completing **12.** Choose the correct indirect question. A. He asked where was I going. B. He asked where I was going. C. He asked where am I going. D. He asked where I going was. **13.** Which is correct? A. She is more better than me. B. She is better than me. C. She is most better than me. D. She is very better than me. **14.** He cut the paper ___ a knife. A. by B. with C. from D. at **15.** The teacher praised the student. Choose the passive form. A. The student praised the teacher. B. The student was praised by the teacher. C. The student is praised by the teacher. D. The student had praised the teacher. **16.** Which sentence uses a non-finite form as a noun? A. He is running. B. Running is good exercise. C. He runs daily. D. He ran yesterday. **17.** Choose the correct option: There are ___ students in the room. A. much B. little C. many D. a little **18.** Choose the correct word: The school ___ addressed the assembly. A. principal B. principle C. principally D. principled **19.** Choose the correct sentence. A. He discussed about the problem. B. He discussed the problem. C. He discussed on the problem. D. He discussed for the problem. **20.** Choose the correct sentence. A. He asked where was she going. B. He asked where she was going. C. He asked where is she going. D. He asked where going she was.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Key Point
1	B	Abstract noun
2	B	vowel sound in honest
3	C	did + V1
4	C	everyone → singular verb
5	B	since + starting point
6	B	modal + V1
7	C	adverb of manner
8	C	did + V1
9	C	subject = quality
10	B	university begins with consonant sound
11	C	future perfect
12	B	indirect-question word order
13	B	no double comparison
14	B	instrument → with
15	B	past simple passive
16	B	gerund functioning as noun
17	C	many + countable plural noun
18	A	principal = school head
19	B	discuss + object
20	B	statement word order

 Exam Tip

****Practice Method:**** After every wrong answer, return to the relevant rule and solve one fresh example. Detailed notes are meant for understanding, not only memorisation.



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